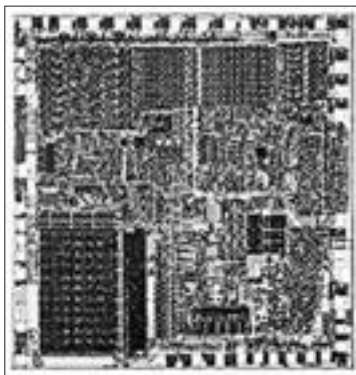


(an Intel employee and an ex-Busicom engineer) with contributions from Stan Mazor (an Intel employee). It had processing logic that made the porting of old applications easier. The chip was used in the Altair 8800, the personal computer then popular amongst computer hobbyists. The 8080 family is regarded the first truly usable microprocessor, and it also became a standard in the industry for microcomputers.



The 8080 was the first truly usable CPU design from the x86 family, created for any application

On the other hand, Motorola announced the MC6800 8-bit microprocessor which didn't use any support chips. It was considered better than the Intel 8080: it was more easy to use since it required a single power supply. It was sold more for industrial control requirement rather than general-purpose computing requirements.



Computing got a boost since the 6800 was better than Intel's processors for an industrial environment

August: Chips Get Cheaper

Forrest Mims and Ed Roberts along with Stan Cagle and Robert Zaller founded Micro Instrumentation and Telemetry Systems (MITS) in 1969, and sold radio transmitters and instruments for model rockets. They had plans for a microcomputer. While Intel sold their 8080 chips at above \$300, Roberts got into a deal with Intel and for chips with surface defects for only \$75.

A working sample of the microcomputer kit—called the Altair—was soon ready, and was formally launched in Popular Electronics' January 1975 edition.